

Excel Analysis — Step-by-Step Guide

Day 2 of 7 — Perfume_Dashboard.xlsx & Pivot_Tables.xlsx

What's in This Folder

- **Perfume_Dashboard.xlsx** — Dashboard sheet with 6 live KPIs and 5 charts, plus a Summary_Tables sheet of SUMIFS/COUNTIFS formulas feeding those charts.
- **Pivot_Tables.xlsx** — Raw data formatted as an Excel Table ("PerfumeSalesTable") ready for PivotTables, plus 3 pre-built pivot-style cross-tabs (Brand x Category, City x Delivery Status, Month x Category).

Step 1 — Explore the Raw Data

- Open Pivot_Tables.xlsx and go to the Raw_Data sheet.
- Confirm 3,000 rows x 15 columns using Ctrl+End to jump to the last cell.
- Use Data > Filter to check unique values in City, Brand, Category, Payment_Method, and Delivery_Status.
- Select Total_Amount column and check the status bar (bottom-right) for Sum, Average, Count — a fast sanity check before building anything.

Step 2 — Build a Live PivotTable Yourself

- Click anywhere inside the PerfumeSalesTable, then Insert > PivotTable.
- Choose 'New Worksheet' and click OK.
- Drag **Brand** to Rows, **Category** to Columns, **Total_Amount** to Values (set to Sum) — this recreates Pivot_Brand_x_Category interactively.
- Try swapping fields: drag **City** to Rows and **Delivery_Status** to Columns with Order_ID (Count) in Values to recreate Pivot_City_x_Status.
- Right-click any value cell > Value Field Settings to switch between Sum, Count, and Average — this is the core skill interviewers look for.

Step 3 — Read the Pre-Built Pivot Sheets

- Pivot_Brand_x_Category — shows which brands lean Men/Women/Unisex and where the revenue concentrates.
- Pivot_City_x_Status — shows return/cancellation counts per city, useful for spotting regional fulfilment issues.
- Pivot_Month_x_Category — shows the seasonal category mix driving revenue swings around Diwali, Valentine's, and New Year.

Step 4 — Review the Dashboard

- Open Perfume_Dashboard.xlsx and go to the Dashboard sheet.
- Review the 6 KPIs: Total Revenue, Total Orders, Average Order Value, Unique Customers, Return Rate, Cancellation Rate.
- Review the 5 charts: Revenue by City (bar), Revenue by Brand (bar), Orders by Category (pie), Orders by Payment Method (pie), Monthly Revenue Trend (line).
- Click into any KPI or chart data cell to see the live formula behind it — nothing is hardcoded.

Step 5 — Practice Talking About It

In an interview, be ready to explain: (1) why you used SUMIFS/COUNTIFS instead of hardcoding values, (2) the difference between a formula-driven summary table and a native Excel PivotTable, and (3) one specific insight you found while building this (e.g., 'Premium brands had a noticeably higher return rate, which led me to recommend better fragrance sampling on the product page').

Formulas Used (Reference)

Formula	Purpose
SUMIFS(sum_range, criteria_range, criteria)	Sum revenue matching one or more conditions
COUNTIFS(criteria_range, criteria)	Count orders matching one or more conditions
SUMPRODUCT((YEAR(range)=y)*(MONTH(range)=m)*range2)	Sum by month without a helper column
SUMPRODUCT(1/COUNTIF(range, range))	Count unique values (e.g., unique customers)